

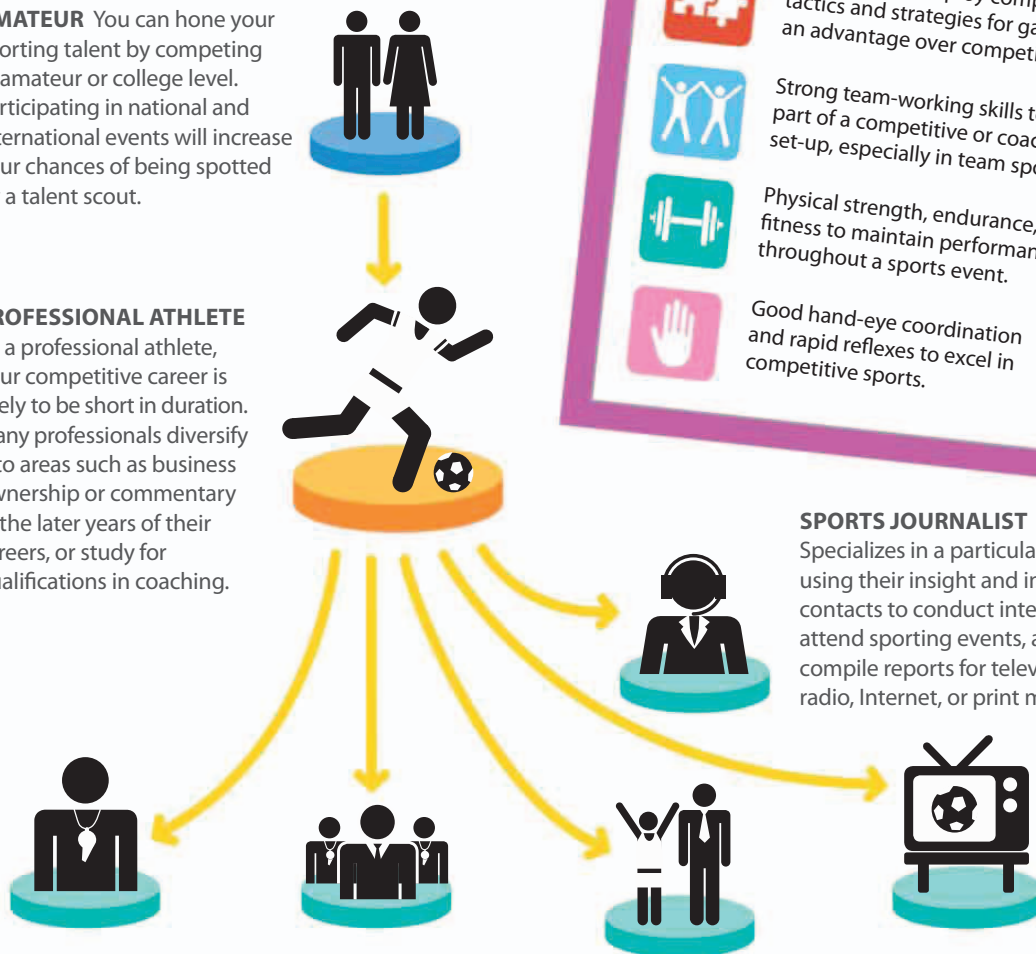
## CAREER PATHS

There is no defined career path for professional athletes, but most naturally talented individuals achieve some success as children, before working with coaches at college or amateur level. Early retirement is common due to the physical demands of professional sports, and many ex-athletes move into media or management.

**AMATEUR** You can hone your sporting talent by competing at amateur or college level. Participating in national and international events will increase your chances of being spotted by a talent scout.

### PROFESSIONAL ATHLETE

As a professional athlete, your competitive career is likely to be short in duration. Many professionals diversify into areas such as business ownership or commentary in the later years of their careers, or study for qualifications in coaching.



### SKILLS GUIDE



Absolute dedication to improve and maintain individual athletic skill and physical fitness.



The ability to employ competitive tactics and strategies for gaining an advantage over competitors.



Strong team-working skills to be part of a competitive or coaching set-up, especially in team sports.



Physical strength, endurance, and fitness to maintain performance throughout a sports event.



Good hand-eye coordination and rapid reflexes to excel in competitive sports.

### SPORTS JOURNALIST

Specializes in a particular sport, using their insight and industry contacts to conduct interviews, attend sporting events, and compile reports for television, radio, Internet, or print media.

**COACH** Trains promising competitors or sports teams. This specialized area requires additional qualifications, which sportspeople can study for during their playing careers.

**MANAGER** Works with professional, school, or college sportspeople to manage teams, resources, and training. Managers may also direct an organization's athletics program or manage sports facilities.

### SPORTS AGENT

Represents a professional sportsperson in the negotiation of contracts and sponsorships, and often handles their public relations and finances.

### SPORTS COMMENTATOR

Provides live commentary and analysis for sports events that are broadcast on television, radio, or the Internet. This job is open to sports personalities with media presentation skills.